1. It is near the town of Arzimas, between Cheliabinsk and the Ural Mountains.

2. After their successful test of a bomb based on the American design, the Soviets returned to their own design, constructed a bomb based on it, and tested it successfully in 1951.

3. Sakharov has speculated that this design was directly inspired by information acquired from the Americans through espionage, perhaps via the spy Klaus Fuchs. Zel'dovich by contrast has asserted that neither Fuchs nor any other spy produced any significant information about the superbomb that his design team did not already know; the principal value of the Soviet superbomb espionage was to convince Soviet political authorities that their physicists knew what they were doing.

4. Just for the record, I strongly disagree with Wheeler (though he is one of my closest friends and my mentor) and with Sakharov. For thoughtful and knowledgeable insights into the Teller–Oppenheimer controversy and the pros and cons of the American debate over whether to build the superbomb, I recommend reading Bethe (1982) and York (1976). For Sakharov's view, see Sakharov (1990); for a critique of Sakharov's view, see Bethe (1990). For a transcript of the Oppenheimer hearings, see USAEC (1954).

5. Finkelstein's insight had actually been found earlier, in other contexts by other physicists including Arthur Eddington; but they had not understood its significance and it was quickly forgotten.